Question ID 9bbce683

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in two variables	

ID: 9bbce683

x	y
18	130
23	160
26	178

For line h, the table shows three values of x and their corresponding values of y. Line k is the result of translating line h down 5 units in the *xy*-plane. What is the *x*-intercept of line k?

A. $\left(-\frac{26}{3}, 0\right)$

B. $\left(-\frac{9}{2}, 0\right)$

C. $\left(-\frac{11}{3}, 0\right)$

D. $\left(-\frac{17}{6}, 0\right)$

ID: 9bbce683 Answer

Correct Answer:
D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. The equation of line h can be written in slope-intercept form $y = mx + b$, where m is the slope of the line and $(0, b)$ is the *y*-intercept of the line. It's given that line h contains the points $(18, 130)$, $(23, 160)$, and $(26, 178)$. Therefore, its slope m can be found as $\frac{160-130}{23-18}$, or 6. Substituting 6 for m in the equation $y = mx + b$ yields $y = 6x + b$. Substituting 130 for y and 18 for x in this equation yields $130 = 6(18) + b$, or $130 = 108 + b$. Subtracting 108 from both sides of this equation yields $22 = b$. Substituting 22 for b in $y = 6x + b$ yields $y = 6x + 22$. Since line k is the result of translating line h down 5 units, an equation of line k is $y = 6x + 22 - 5$, or $y = 6x + 17$. Substituting 0 for y in this equation yields $0 = 6x + 17$. Solving this equation for x yields $x = -\frac{17}{6}$. Therefore, the *x*-intercept of line k is $\left(-\frac{17}{6}, 0\right)$.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Question Difficulty:
Hard